

Specialised keyboards

Gaming

Gaming keyboards form the higher end of the keyboard pricing spectrum with features most haven't even heard of. NKRO is a common feature for almost all mid-range and high-end keyboard. Another common feature is backlighting, when you are typing normally any error encountered is fixed with a backspace or the delete key, this is not the case with gaming. A mistake could possibly mean the loss of hours worth of effort and this can be quite frustrating. So during those intense moments we gamers like to make sure which key we are pressing and having a backlight helps immensely at night. But it has to be ambient, overly bright lights are rather distracting at night. Also most gaming keyboards use more durable switches for WASD since they are the most used keys while gaming.

Macro keys are quite a useful function whether you are gaming or not, the ability to store a sequence of keystrokes so that you can use just one key instead of repeating the entire sequence is quite convenient. Macros are not limited to just gaming keyboards but are there in normal high end keyboards as well.

Ergonomic

While ergonomics is a factor that is part and parcel of any product design, there does exist a market for people who've been afflicted with some malady or the other (like arthritis or carpal



tunnel syndrome) and have to resort to a much stress free layout. Ergonomic keyboards tend to come with special attachments to adjust the rest pad's height or depth altogether. They can be split in half down the middle and the angle between them adjusted to suit the user's natural arm resting position.

What to buy

When looking to buy a keyboard keep the following points in mind.

1. Mechanical keyboards are much more durable and last longer.
2. Opt for a spill-proof design whenever possible.
3. If you are going in for a mechanical keyboard try out the keyboard before buying to see if you prefer the key type, whether you prefer the